

those who became eyewitnesses, from the beginning, and ministers of the Word delivered them to us,¹ it seemed good to me also, most excellent Theophilus, having taken careful note of everything from **Above**, to write to you with precision and in sequence,² so that you may know the certainty of the things in which you were instructed.³

It will be noticed that I rendered “everything from Above”, rather than ‘everything from the beginning’. The normal meaning of the Greek word here, *ανωθεν*, is precisely ‘from above’, and I see no reason to reject that meaning. The more so since in the prior verse he already used the normal phrase, *απ αρχης*, that means ‘from the beginning’. I take it that Luke is claiming divine inspiration, up front.

Now I will consider a few verses where one apostle recognizes that another is writing Scripture. I begin with 1 Timothy 5:18. “For the Scripture says: ‘You shall not muzzle an ox while it treads out grain’, and ‘The worker is worthy of his wages’”. The part about the ox is a quote from Deuteronomy 25:4, definitely Scripture, but the part about the worker is a quote from Luke 10:7! Now this is very instructive. Paul, a former Pharisee, presumably ascribed the highest level of inspiration to the five books of the Law, so we expect him to call Deuteronomy Scripture. But for him to place Luke on a par with Moses is little short of incredible. Although there may have been close to fifteen years between the ‘publishing’ of Luke and the writing of 1 Timothy, Luke was recognized and declared by apostolic authority to be Scripture not long after it came off the press, so to speak. For a man who was once a strict Pharisee to put Luke (still alive) on a level with Moses is astounding; it would have required the direction of the Holy Spirit. Indeed, if Paul wrote this letter under the inspiration of the Holy Spirit, as I believe, then God Himself is declaring Luke to be Scripture!

In 2 Peter 3:15-16, Peter puts the Epistles of Paul on the same level as “the other Scriptures”. Although some had been out for perhaps fifteen years, the ink was scarcely dry on others, and perhaps 2 Timothy had not yet been penned when Peter wrote. Paul’s writings were recognized and declared by apostolic authority to be Scripture as soon as they appeared.

¹ Luke insists that his information comes from responsible eyewitnesses, who were there all the time.

² In fact, with a few exceptions, Luke’s narrative is in chronological sequence, and as a physician he doubtless valued precision.

³ Given Luke’s stated purpose in writing, his account needs to be historically accurate. Note that Theophilus had already received some instruction.